Sprint 3 – StudyPlanner Usability Testing Report

Project: Group 62 – StudyPlanner
Role: UX/UI Designer
Testing Method: Moderated usability testing
Participants: 3
Duration: 20 minutes per participant
Overall Outcome: Successful

1. Testing Objective

The usability testing aimed to evaluate the StudyPlanner website's overall user experience, focusing on course selection, Programming Project 1 eligibility warnings, co-requisite warnings, and navigation.

The goal was to ensure that users could complete common study planning tasks easily and that the implemented interface was consistent with the approved Figma designs.

2. Testing Tasks

Four tasks were prepared:

1. Add an available course to the study plan.
2. Select Programming Project 1 and understand the eligibility warning.
3. Select a course with a co-requisite requirement and understand the warning.
4. Navigate back to the study plan and modify selected courses.

3. Testing Results

Task	Participant 1	Participant 2	Participant 3
Add a course	Pass	Pass	Pass
Eligibility warning	Pass	Pass	Pass
Co-requisite warning	Pass	Pass	Pass
Navigation	Pass	Pass	Pass

Overall task completion rate: 100% (12/12 tasks)

4. Participant Feedback

Participant 1 – Mei Ann Goh (S4078465)

Found the website straightforward to navigate, with an intuitive course selection process. Both warning messages were easy to understand. However, the repeated co-requisite warning at the bottom of the page made the interface feel slightly cluttered, as the same issue was already highlighted elsewhere.

Participant 2 – Aiza Fontanilla (S4015983)

Successfully completed all four tasks without assistance. Found the warning messages clear and appreciated having the option to continue or go back. However, the additional co-requisite warning banner at the bottom seemed unnecessary and could be removed or repositioned for a cleaner interface.

Participant 3 – Hui Wen Chew (S3993540)

Found the website generally consistent and easy to use, with no difficulty adding courses or navigating between pages. However, the small "X" button in the Summer Semester section appeared out of place, making its purpose unclear. Suggested repositioning or removing the button to improve visual consistency.

5. Usability Findings

In this testing scenario:

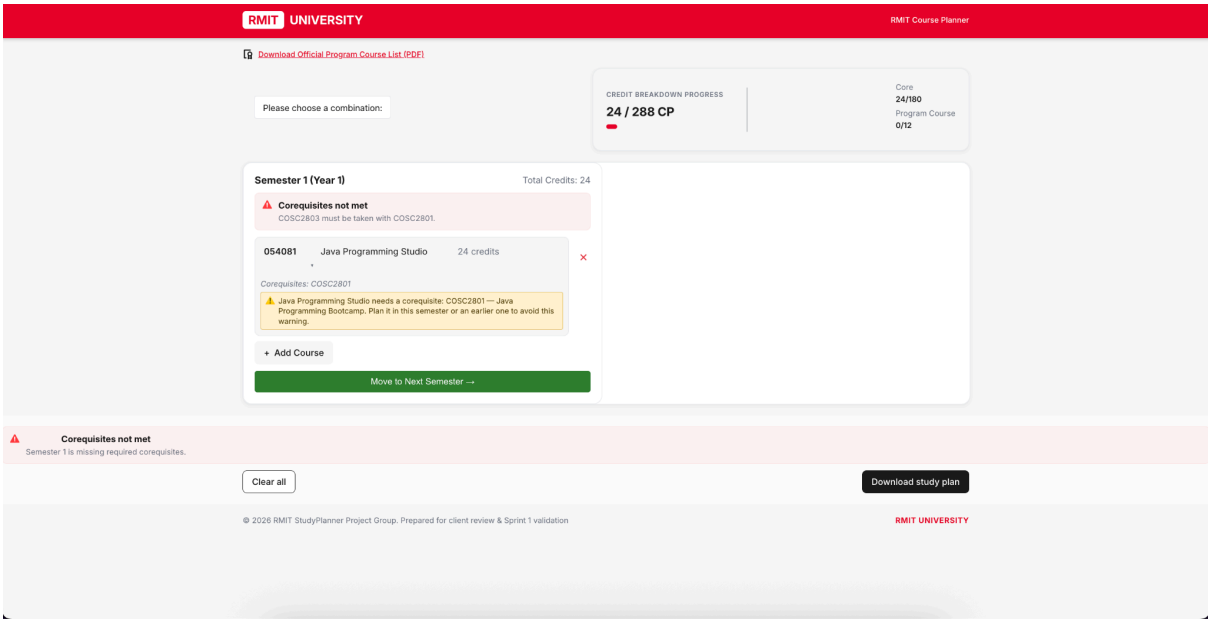
- All participants completed the assigned tasks successfully.
- Eligibility and co-requisite warnings were clearly displayed and understood.
- Warning actions worked as expected.
- Course selection and navigation were intuitive.
- No major usability issues were identified.
- The website appeared consistent with the approved Figma designs.

Minor Usability Issue – Repeated Co-requisite Warning

One minor usability issue identified was the repeated display of the same co-requisite warning. The warning already appears within the semester section and the individual course card, but an additional red "Corequisites not met" banner is also displayed at the bottom of the page.

Although the warning is useful, displaying it multiple times makes the interface feel unnecessarily cluttered and may give users the impression that several errors have occurred when there is only one missing co-requisite.

Severity: Low–Medium
Impact: Visual clutter and unnecessary emphasis on a single issue.

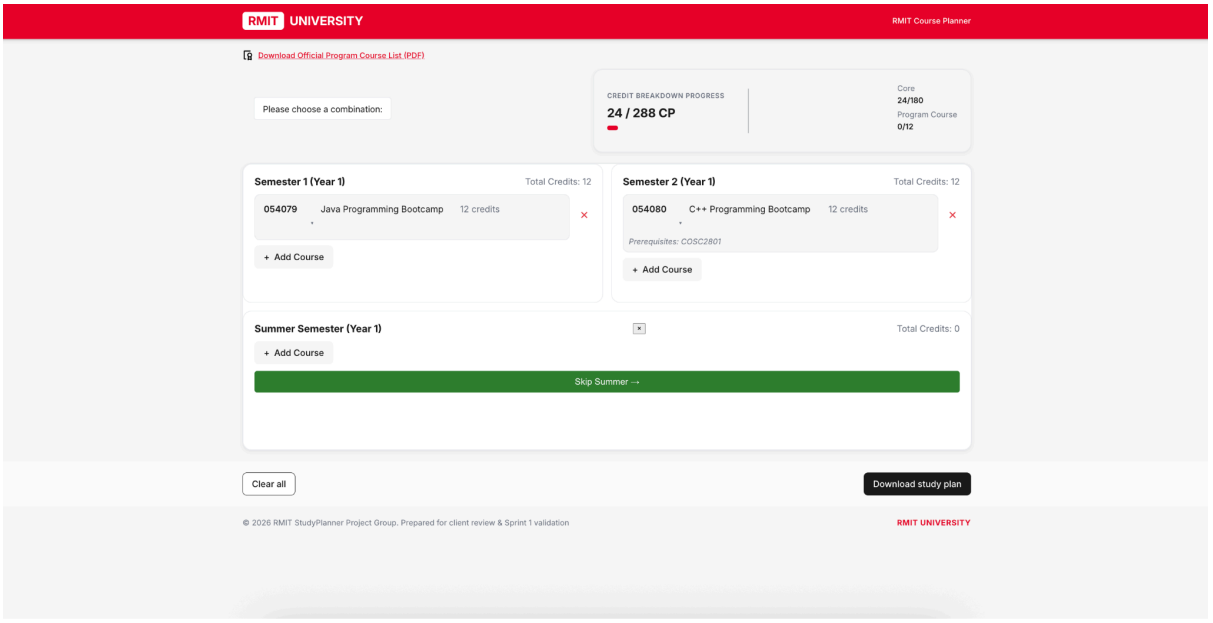


Minor Usability Issue – Misplaced Summer Semester Remove Button

A small "X" button appears near the top-middle of the Summer Semester section. Its purpose is unclear, and its positioning looks inconsistent with the rest of the interface.

The button appears visually disconnected from the semester controls and may confuse users about its intended function.

Severity: Low
Impact: Minor visual inconsistency and unclear button functionality.



6. Recommendations

Although no major usability issues were identified in this scenario, the following improvements are recommended for future development:

- Maintain consistent warning styling across all courses.
- Continue reviewing visual consistency when implementing new features.
- Conduct additional usability testing when significant changes are introduced.

Improve Co-requisite Warning Placement

Consider removing the bottom "Corequisites not met" banner, as the warning is already clearly communicated within the semester section and course card.

Alternatively, the banner could be repositioned closer to the relevant course or displayed only when additional attention is required.

This would reduce unnecessary visual clutter, avoid making a single issue appear more serious than it is, and provide a cleaner, more balanced user experience.

Improve Summer Semester Remove Button Placement

If the "X" button is intended to remove or close the Summer Semester section, it should be repositioned to the top-right corner of the semester card and styled consistently with other controls.

Alternatively, if the button is unnecessary because the "Skip Summer" action already provides the intended functionality, it should be removed to avoid confusion and duplicate controls.

7. Team Handoff Summary

The usability testing results indicate that the StudyPlanner website provides a clear and intuitive experience for the tested course planning flows.

All three participants successfully completed the four tasks, and no major usability concerns were identified.

The findings suggest that the eligibility warnings, co-requisite warnings, and navigation meet the intended design requirements.

One minor UX improvement was identified regarding the repeated co-requisite warning at the bottom of the page. It is recommended that the banner be removed or repositioned to reduce visual clutter, as the same warning is already displayed elsewhere in the interface. This is a low-priority improvement and does not prevent users from completing their tasks.

Another minor UX issue was identified in the Summer Semester section, where an "X" button appears in an unusual position. It is recommended that the button be repositioned or removed if redundant, to improve interface consistency and clarity.

9. Conclusion

Overall, the usability testing went well, with all three participants successfully completing the four tasks.

Participants found the course selection process straightforward and were able to understand the eligibility and co-requisite warnings without difficulty.

Two minor UX issues were identified: the repeated co-requisite warning at the bottom of the page and the misplaced "X" button in the Summer Semester section.

These issues did not prevent participants from completing their tasks, but addressing them would help make the interface cleaner and easier to understand.

Based on the results, no major UX changes are required before the final submission.